VAUTRIN OS

Design System for the Revenue & Operations Workspace

A minimalist, operationally dense visual language for the Nuxt/Vue web application. Designed for contractors and local-business teams who need to understand leads, conversations, appointments, workflows and AI actions without dashboard clutter.

Direction	Primary mode	Accent	Density
Quiet precision	Light	Signal orange	Compact, readable

Core principle

Vautrin should feel like an operating console, not a template marketplace. The interface is calm by default; color appears only where it carries state, risk, progress or action.

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01 Design intent

The product is a CRM and AI operations workspace, so the first application viewport is allowed to be a dashboard. Even then, it must read as one deliberate composition rather than a collage of cards. The uploaded frontend rules prioritize brand presence, purposeful typography, non-flat atmosphere, minimal cards, one job per section, reduced clutter, intentional motion, and responsive behavior. This system translates those constraints into product UI.

Personality

Attribute	Meaning in UI	Avoid
Precise	Aligned grids, explicit states, predictable actions	Decorative complexity
Calm	Neutral surfaces, restrained accent usage	Rainbow dashboards
Operational	Tables, timelines, queues and status are first-class	Marketing-style feature tiles
Human	Plain labels and useful empty states	Robotic AI language
Premium	Typography, spacing and material restraint	Heavy shadows, glassmorphism, gradients everywhere

Visual references

CRM inspiration was used directionally: clear hierarchy, strong sidebar/navigation, data-first composition, soft neutral backgrounds, subtle separators and restrained accent color. The design must not copy any specific Dribbble shot; it should preserve Vautrin's own identity and operational requirements.

Non-negotiable rules

• Do not create a card for every metric. Prefer shared surfaces, rows, dividers and grouped sections.

• Do not use purple as a default AI/SaaS signal. AI is represented by behavior and labeling, not neon decoration.

• No dark-mode-first design. Light mode is the reference implementation.

• One primary action per page header. Secondary actions stay visually subordinate.

• Use color to encode state or action; never to fill empty space.

02 Color system

The palette combines warm-neutral surfaces with graphite text and a burnt signal-orange accent. The result should feel architectural and practical rather than playful.

	Ink #111512	`--v-ink`	Primary text, high-emphasis icons
	Graphite #29312C	`--v-ink-2`	Secondary headings, dense table text
	Muted #66706A	`--v-muted`	Supporting copy, labels
	Canvas #F6F7F5	`--v-canvas`	Application background
	Surface #FFFFFF	`--v-surface`	Primary working surfaces
	Subtle Surface #EFF2EF	`--v-surface-2`	Hover, grouped rows, filters
	Border #DDE3DE	`--v-border`	Dividers, inputs, table rules
	Signal Orange #E45E2B	`--v-accent`	Primary CTA, selected/high-attention state
	Accent Soft #FFF0E9	`--v-accent-soft`	Low-emphasis accent background
	Success #2E7D57	`--v-success`	Completed, won, connected
	Warning #A86F17	`--v-warning`	Needs attention, waiting
	Danger #C54C4C	`--v-danger`	Failure, destructive actions
	Info #356AA5	`--v-info`	Informational/system states

Usage ratio

~80% neutrals / ~15% structural contrast / ≤5% accent + semantic color. Orange is not a background theme. It is a signal.

03 Typography

Implementation font: Geist for interface and product copy; Geist Mono for IDs, technical values, tokens and diagnostic data. Geist is compact enough for CRM density while remaining distinctive and modern. Do not fall back to Inter, Roboto or Arial as the authored design choice.

Role	Size / line	Weight	Use
Display	32 / 38	600	Rare: onboarding, major empty states
Page title	24 / 30	600	Leads, Conversations, Appointments
Section title	16 / 22	600	Major content regions
Body	14 / 20	400	Primary interface copy
Body strong	14 / 20	550-600	Names, primary row values
Small	12 / 16	400	Metadata, timestamps, helper text
Label	11 / 14	600	Upper-level field labels; +0.02em tracking
Mono	12 / 18	400	IDs, event keys, token/cost values

Rules

- Use sentence case everywhere except compact technical labels and event names.
- Never use more than three font weights on one screen.
- Numeric KPI values use tabular numerals where supported.
- Names and operational values outrank labels. Labels should never compete with the data.
- Line length for prose: 45-75 characters. Operational tables are exempt.

Example hierarchy

Good morning, Alex.

Here is what needs attention across your revenue pipeline.

12 leads need follow-up

4 have been waiting more than 24 hours.

04 Layout, grid & spacing

Desktop is the primary operations environment, but every workflow must remain functional on mobile. Use a 4px base unit and an 8px rhythm for most composition.

Token	Value	Use
--space-1	4px	Icon/text micro-gap
--space-2	8px	Inline control gap
--space-3	12px	Dense row padding
--space-4	16px	Standard component padding
--space-5	20px	Section internal spacing
--space-6	24px	Page groups
--space-8	32px	Major section separation
--space-12	48px	Large empty states/onboarding

Desktop shell

Region	Specification
Sidebar	240px expanded; 72px compact; fixed on desktop
Top utility bar	56px; search, tenant switcher, notifications, user menu
Main content	max 1440px; 24-32px page padding
Content grid	12 columns; 16-24px gutters
Right context panel	360-420px; only when entity context is useful

Breakpoints

≥1280px: full sidebar + multi-column workspace. 768-1279px: compact sidebar + reduced columns. <768px: bottom/overlay navigation, single-column content, contextual panels become sheets.

Composition rule

A dashboard may contain multiple data regions, but the viewport still needs one dominant reading path: attention → pipeline → activity. Do not make every module equally loud.

05 Shape, borders & elevation

Vautrin uses surfaces, not card stacks. Structure should come from spacing and 1px separators before shadows.

Element	Radius	Border	Shadow
Buttons	8px	None / 1px secondary	None
Inputs	8px	1px --v-border	Focus ring only
Interactive panels	12px	1px --v-border	0 8px 24px rgba(17,21,18,.06)
Popover/menu	10px	1px --v-border	0 12px 32px rgba(17,21,18,.10)
Modal	14px	1px --v-border	0 24px 64px rgba(17,21,18,.16)
Table/group surface	0-12px	Prefer dividers	None

Card rule

Create a card only when the boundary helps interaction or comprehension: e.g. a draggable pipeline deal, a selectable integration, or a bounded AI approval. KPI cards are not the default. Prefer an inline metrics strip separated by vertical rules.

Do

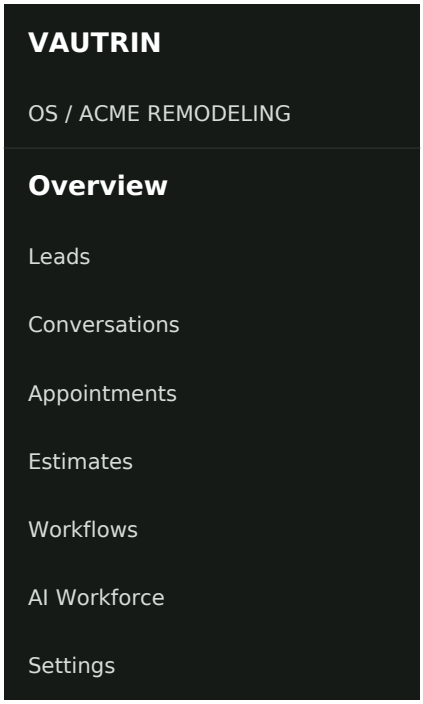
- Use whitespace and hairline borders to establish hierarchy.
- Let tables and timelines touch their parent surface edge when that improves scanability.
- Reserve elevation for transient layers: popovers, dialogs, sheets.

Do not

- Nest cards inside cards.
- Use large 20-32px radii across enterprise UI.
- Apply shadows to every dashboard block.

06 Application shell & navigation

The shell must make the Vautrin brand visible without consuming operational space. The product name is a strong signal at the top of the sidebar; the active tenant sits beneath it as context, not as the brand.



Navigation rules

• Primary navigation reflects durable product domains, not implementation modules.

• Maximum 7 primary destinations before grouping secondary areas under Settings/More.

• Selected state: subtle neutral or accent-soft background + 2px accent indicator; not a bright full-width pill.

• AI Workforce is a destination only when it exposes operational status/actions. AI should not become a decorative nav category.

• Tenant switching must be obvious but visually secondary to the Vautrin brand.

07 Core components

The component library should optimize repeatability across CRM, conversations, workflows and settings.

Component	Specification
Primary button	Orange fill, white text, 36-40px height. One dominant CTA per region.
Secondary button	White/transparent, 1px border, graphite text.
Ghost button	No border; hover uses --v-surface-2. Utility actions only.
Destructive button	Danger text by default; solid danger only for final destructive confirmation.
Text input	40px height, 8px radius, visible label, helper/error below.
Select/combobox	Same geometry as input. Search for >8 options.
Tabs	Text + underline/indicator. Avoid pill tabs unless they are true segmented controls.
Status badge	Compact semantic label; low-saturation background; never use status color for body text.
Avatar	24/32/40px. Initial fallback. Do not overuse in operational tables.
Tooltip	Short explanation only. Never hide required information inside it.
Toast	Transient confirmation; actions that matter also persist in entity history/audit.
Empty state	One sentence, one action, optional purposeful illustration. No marketing copy.

Iconography

Use a single outlined icon family with 1.5-2px stroke, 16/18/20px sizes. Icons support labels; they do not replace labels for primary navigation or destructive actions. Recommended implementation families: Lucide or Phosphor (regular weight), chosen once and used consistently.

08 CRM & pipeline patterns

CRM screens are data-first. The user's job is to find, qualify and advance opportunities quickly.

Leads list

Lead	Stage	Last contact	Next action	Owner
Maria Johnson	Qualified	12 min ago	Site visit · Sep 26	Alex
Robert Miller	Contacted	2 h ago	Follow up today	AI + Alex
Sarah Davis	New	8 min ago	Qualify	AI
David Wilson	Estimate sent	Yesterday	Follow up · Sep 25	Alex

Rules

• Default to table/list for high-density lead management; Kanban is a secondary pipeline view.

• Lead name and next action are the strongest row signals.

• AI ownership must be explicit: 'AI', human name, or 'AI + human'.

• Filters live in a compact toolbar, not a row of colorful chips.

• Bulk actions appear only after selection.

Pipeline

Kanban columns use stage labels and counts. Deal cards are one of the justified card patterns because drag/drop is an interaction boundary. Cards contain only name, value/project type, age, next action and owner. No decorative charts inside cards.

09 Conversations & AI interaction

The conversation workspace is a three-part composition: queue, thread, context. On smaller screens, context becomes a drawer/sheet.

Region	Purpose	Priority
Inbox queue	Unread, waiting, assigned, channel, SLA age	Fast scanning
Conversation thread	Human/customer/AI messages and system events	Primary focus
Context panel	Lead, qualification, appointment, estimate, AI state	On-demand

AI visual language

• AI messages do not use gradients, sparkles or purple chrome.

• Identify AI authorship with a small 'Vautrin AI' label and agent name where relevant.

• Tool actions render as quiet timeline events: 'Checked availability', 'Updated lead stage', 'Scheduled appointment'.

• Human handoff is a state transition, not an error.

• Potentially sensitive actions require a visible approval row with Approve / Reject.

Message bubbles

Customer: neutral surface with border. Human operator: graphite-tinted or subtle accent-soft surface. AI: same base surface as operator, differentiated by label and metadata rather than a different visual universe.

Trust rule

Never imply the AI completed an external action until the provider/tool confirms success. UI state must distinguish drafted → queued → sent → delivered → failed.

10 Data visualization & outcomes

Vautrin analytics should answer 'what happened and what needs attention?', not showcase charting.

Metric	Preferred treatment
New leads / response time / bookings	Inline metric strip with small delta
Pipeline conversion	Horizontal funnel or stage progression
Lead volume over time	Single-series line chart
Revenue influenced	Line/bar with methodology link
AI activity	Counts + outcome rates, not token charts
Workflow health	Success/failure/latency table; sparklines only if useful

Chart rules

- One accent series by default. Additional series use neutral tones before new saturated colors.
- No 3D, gauges, donuts for more than 4 categories, or decorative area fills.
- Always label units and time range.
- Use semantic red/green only for negative/positive state, not arbitrary series identity.
- Revenue influenced must expose its attribution methodology; do not visually imply causal certainty.

Outcome hierarchy

Primary: leads captured, missed calls recovered, response time, appointments booked, estimates followed up. Secondary: workflow runs, AI actions, handoffs. Diagnostic: tokens, model latency, provider failures and cost - available to admins, not dominant for business users.

11 Forms, feedback & system states

Forms should feel like configuration, not paperwork. Group by task and reveal advanced controls progressively.

State	Treatment
Hover	Subtle surface shift; no dramatic scale
Focus	2px accent ring with 2px offset; WCAG-visible
Selected	Accent indicator + subtle background
Disabled	Reduced contrast; preserve label readability
Loading	Skeleton for content; spinner only for bounded actions
Success	Inline confirmation + persisted history when operationally relevant
Error	Specific inline error; preserve user input
Empty	Explain why empty + one next action

Validation

- Validate on blur/submit; do not show red errors before the user interacts.
- Error copy explains recovery: 'Phone number is required to receive lead replies.'
- Never rely on color alone; pair semantic color with text/icon.

Destructive flows

Use progressive friction. Low-risk removal may be one confirmation. High-risk actions such as deleting customer data, disabling a phone integration, or changing an automation with active jobs require explicit impact copy.

12 Motion & interaction

Motion creates continuity and confidence. It must never make the CRM feel like a consumer landing page.

Motion	Duration	Behavior
Navigation/content transition	160-220ms	Fade + 4-8px translate
Context panel / sheet	220-280ms	Slide with opacity
Row update / new event	180-240ms	Brief highlight fade
Popover/menu	120-160ms	Opacity + 2-4px scale/translate
Drag/drop pipeline	Direct manipulation	No ornamental easing

Required intentional motions

• Conversation: new incoming message enters with subtle vertical continuity.

• Pipeline: stage transition visibly resolves into the destination column.

• AI/tool activity: a compact in-progress state transitions to confirmed/failed without layout jump.

Accessibility

Respect `prefers-reduced-motion`. Reduced mode removes translation/scale and keeps only essential opacity/state changes.

13 Responsive behavior

Mobile is not a shrunk desktop dashboard. Preserve the task, then change the composition.

Desktop pattern	Mobile adaptation
Persistent sidebar	Compact top bar + drawer/bottom destinations
Table	Priority columns + horizontal scroll or entity list
3-pane conversation	Queue → thread → context sheet
Kanban	Horizontal stage lanes or stage-filtered list
Right context panel	Bottom sheet / full-screen detail
Inline action group	Primary action visible; secondary actions in menu

Mobile rules

- 44px minimum interactive target where practical.
- Do not hide operational status to save space.
- Do not convert every row into a decorative rounded card.
- Keep primary action reachable without requiring horizontal scrolling.
- Sticky action bars are acceptable for high-frequency flows such as lead qualification.

14 Accessibility & content

Area	Rule
Contrast	Target WCAG 2.2 AA: 4.5:1 normal text; 3:1 large text/UI graphics.
Keyboard	All actions reachable; visible focus; logical DOM order.
Semantics	Use native button/link/input/table semantics before ARIA.
Status	Never color-only; include text/icon and accessible label.
Live updates	Use polite announcements for meaningful async updates; avoid noisy streams.
Language	Plain operational English. Prefer 'Send follow-up' over 'Execute communication workflow'.
Time	Show local business time; make timezone explicit in scheduling surfaces.

Voice & tone

• Concise, calm, accountable.

• Use verbs for actions: Send, Assign, Schedule, Approve, Retry.

• Avoid anthropomorphic claims that overstate AI capability.

• Errors say what failed and what the user can do next.

Examples

Good: 'Message failed to send. Twilio returned an invalid destination number.'
Avoid: 'Oops! Something went wrong.'

Good: 'AI suggested a reply. Review before sending.'
Avoid: 'Your AI employee has everything under control.'

15 Implementation contract

Nuxt/Vue implementation should encode the system as tokens first, then components. Feature code should not introduce arbitrary colors, spacing, radii or shadows.

:root token baseline

```
--v-ink: #111512; --v-ink-2: #29312C; --v-muted: #66706A; --v-canvas: #F6F7F5; --v-surface: #FFFFFF;
--v-surface-2: #EFF2EF; --v-border: #DDE3DE; --v-accent: #E45E2B; --v-accent-hover: #C94D1F;
--v-accent-soft: #FFF0E9; --v-success: #2E7D57; --v-warning: #A86F17; --v-danger: #C54C4C; --v-info:
#356AA5; --radius-control: 8px; --radius-panel: 12px; --radius-modal: 14px; --font-ui: "Geist", sans-serif;
--font-mono: "Geist Mono", monospace;
```

Component governance

• Base components live in a shared UI layer; feature modules compose them.

• No feature-specific hex values unless the design system explicitly adds a token.

• No one-off radius/shadow values in page components.

• Use CSS variables for semantic tokens; do not bind features to raw palette names.

• Create Storybook/Histoire examples for interactive states before multiplying variants.

• Every new component must define: default, hover, focus, disabled, loading, error (when applicable), mobile behavior.

16 Page blueprints

These are composition rules, not wireframes. They define hierarchy for implementation.

Overview

Header: page title + date range + one primary action.
Attention strip: leads waiting, missed calls, follow-ups due, appointments today.
Primary region: pipeline / lead flow.
Secondary region: recent activity + AI actions.
Do not: start with 6-10 isolated KPI cards.

Leads

Header: Leads + Add lead.
Toolbar: search, stage, owner, source, date.
Body: table by default; pipeline toggle optional.
Detail: side context panel or dedicated entity route.

Conversations

Composition: inbox queue / thread / lead context.
Primary action: Send message.
AI: suggestion and tool activity integrated into thread, not a floating chatbot.

Workflows

List: name, trigger, status, last run, success rate.
Editor: linear step composition before visual-node complexity.
Activation: clear draft/active versioning and impact warning.

Settings

Use a stable sub-navigation and long-form sections with dividers. Cards only for selectable integrations or bounded interactive setup flows.

17 Design review checklist

Check	Pass condition
Brand	Vautrin is unmistakable from shell, typography and accent even without marketing copy.
Hierarchy	One dominant reading path; not every module has equal emphasis.
Cards	Every card has a defensible interaction/comprehension reason.
Color	Accent/semantic colors communicate action or state.
Typography	Geist hierarchy; no generic default stack as authored choice.
Density	Operational data is compact but scannable.
AI	AI is explicit, accountable and integrated; no decorative AI chrome.
Motion	2-3 purposeful motions; reduced-motion supported.
Responsive	Task remains complete on mobile, not merely visually compressed.
Accessibility	Keyboard, focus, semantics, contrast and non-color status are verified.
Trust	Async/provider actions show truthful lifecycle states.
Consistency	Tokens/components used; no feature-level visual inventions without review.

Definition of done for frontend implementation

A screen is not done because it matches a screenshot. It is done when loading, empty, error, permission, long-content, mobile, keyboard and async states all follow this system.

Source basis

This system adapts the uploaded Frontend Tasks rules and uses CRM dashboard references from Dribbble directionally for hierarchy, data clarity and minimalist SaaS composition. It intentionally avoids the common purple/white AI aesthetic, excessive card grids and dark-mode-first styling.